

THUNDER

1. Passage anchor

> “Roller coasters **thundered** overhead, music blasted from loudspeakers...”

Passage meaning

thunder = move while making a very loud, deep, powerful noise

轟隆隆地駛過；發出雷鳴般巨響地移動

Here, the roller coasters are not producing literal thunder. Their movement creates a loud, heavy rumbling sound resembling thunder.

Practice

1. The train **thundered** past the station.

火車**轟隆隆地駛過**車站。

2. Trucks **thundered** along the highway throughout the night.

卡車整晚都在公路上**轟隆隆地駛過**。

Core meanings of THUNDER

2. thunder — natural weather sound

As a noun:

= loud, deep sound produced in the atmosphere after lightning

雷聲；**雷鳴**

Examples

1. We heard **thunder** in the distance.

我們聽到遠處的**雷聲**。

2. A loud crash of **thunder** woke me up.

一聲巨大的**雷鳴**把我吵醒了。

This is the central literal sense.

3. thunder — make thunder

As a verb:

= produce the natural sound of thunder

****打雷；雷鳴****

Examples

1. It began to ****thunder**** during the night.

晚上開始****打雷****。

2. The sky ****thundered**** above us.

天空在我們頭頂****雷聲隆隆****。

Loud rumbling sound

4. thunder — very loud deep noise

= a loud, deep, continuous or explosive sound resembling thunder

****轟鳴；雷鳴般的巨響****

Examples

1. We heard the ****thunder of engines****.

我們聽到引擎的****轟鳴聲****。

2. The ****thunder of applause**** filled the hall.

****雷鳴般的掌聲****響徹大廳。

Major figurative noun extension.

5. thunder of applause

= extremely loud applause

****雷鳴般的掌聲****

Examples

1. The performance ended in a ****thunder of applause****.

演出在****雷鳴般的掌聲****中結束。

2. She walked onto the stage to a ****thunder of applause****.

她在**如雷掌聲**中走上舞台。

Move noisily and powerfully

6. thunder — move with a loud rumbling noise

= move quickly or heavily while making a loud, deep sound

轟隆隆地移動；轟鳴而過

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. A train **thundered through** the tunnel.

一列火車**轟隆隆地穿過**隧道。

2. Horses **thundered across** the field.

馬群**轟隆隆地奔過**田野。

7. thunder past / through / along

= move past, through, or along somewhere with great noise and force

轟隆隆地駛過 / 穿過 / 前進

Examples

1. The bus **thundered past** us.

巴士從我們身旁**轟隆隆地駛過**。

2. The roller coaster **thundered along** the track.

過山車沿著軌道**轟隆隆地高速前進**。

Run / charge heavily

8. thunder — rush heavily

= run or charge with heavy, powerful footsteps

轟隆隆地奔跑；重步衝過

Examples

1. The children ****thundered down the stairs****.

孩子們****咚咚作響地衝下樓梯****。

2. He ****thundered across the room****.

他踏著****沉重響亮的腳步****穿過房間。

Speak loudly and forcefully

9. thunder — speak in a very loud, powerful voice

= say something loudly, angrily, or authoritatively

****怒吼；厲聲說；洪亮地說****

Examples

1. “Get out!” he ****thundered****.

「出去！」他****怒吼道****。

2. The speaker ****thundered against**** corruption.

那位講者****義正詞嚴地猛烈抨擊****貪腐。

Distinct figurative verb sense.

10. thunder at / against someone or something

= attack or criticize something in an extremely forceful voice

****大聲斥責；猛烈抨擊****

Examples

1. He ****thundered against**** the decision.

他****猛烈抨擊****那項決定。

2. The coach ****thundered at**** the players from the sideline.

教練在場邊對球員****大聲怒斥****。

THUNDEROUS

11. thunderous — extremely loud

= as loud or powerful as thunder

****雷鳴般的；震耳欲聾的****

Examples

1. The audience gave ****thunderous applause****.

觀眾報以****雷鳴般的掌聲****。

2. There was a ****thunderous crash****.

傳來一聲****震耳欲聾的巨響****。

12. thunderous — strongly expressive / overwhelming

= extremely powerful, forceful, or emphatic

****聲勢浩大的；極具震撼力的****

Examples

1. The announcement received ****thunderous approval****.

那項宣布獲得了****聲勢浩大的支持****。

2. His final line drew a ****thunderous response****.

他的最後一句引起了****極其熱烈的反應****。

THUNDERCLAP

13. thunderclap

= single sudden loud crash of thunder

****霹靂；一聲雷鳴****

Examples

1. A sudden ****thunderclap**** shook the windows.

突然一聲****霹靂****震得窗戶發抖。

2. The silence was broken by a ****thunderclap****.

寂靜被一聲****巨雷****打破。

THUNDERSTORM

14. thunderstorm

= storm involving thunder and lightning, usually with rain

****雷暴；雷雨****

Examples

1. A ****thunderstorm**** developed in the afternoon.

下午出現了一場****雷暴****。

2. The flight was delayed by a ****thunderstorm****.

航班因****雷雨****而延誤。

THUNDERBOLT

15. thunderbolt — lightning / imagined bolt from the sky

= flash or stroke of lightning, especially in literary or mythological contexts

****雷電；霹靂****

Examples

1. Zeus is often shown holding a ****thunderbolt****.

宙斯常被描繪成手持****雷霆****。

2. The tree looked as though it had been struck by a ****thunderbolt****.

那棵樹看起來像被****雷電****擊中。

16. like a thunderbolt

Figurative:

= with sudden, shocking emotional impact

****如晴天霹靂；突然帶來巨大衝擊****

Examples

1. The news came ****like a thunderbolt****.

那個消息有如****晴天霹靂****。

2. The announcement hit the family ****like a thunderbolt****.

那項宣布對這個家庭而言就像****晴天霹靂****。

High-value idioms

17. steal someone's thunder

= take attention, praise, or credit away from someone by doing or announcing something first

****搶某人風頭；搶先一步奪去注意 / 功勞****

Examples

1. I didn't mean to ****steal your thunder**** by announcing my news first.

我不是故意先公布自己的消息來****搶你的風頭****。

2. A rival company ****stole their thunder**** by launching a similar product first.

競爭公司搶先推出類似產品，****搶去了他們的風頭****。

Very high-value idiom.

18. thunder and lightning

= thunder together with lightning during a storm

****雷電；雷鳴閃電****

Examples

1. There was ****thunder and lightning**** all night.

整晚都有****雷鳴閃電****。

2. The children were frightened by the ****thunder and lightning****.

孩子們被****雷電****嚇到了。

19. blood and thunder

Especially BrE:

= exciting, violent, highly dramatic action, especially in stories or performances

****充滿激烈動作與戲劇性的；刀光劍影式的****

Examples

1. It is a classic **blood-and-thunder adventure**.
那是一個典型、充滿激烈動作的**冒險故事**。
2. The production has plenty of **blood and thunder**.
這齣作品充滿**激烈刺激的戲劇場面**。

Lower priority but established.

Related forms

20. thundering — making a very loud noise

= producing a loud, heavy sound

轟隆作響的；震耳的

Examples

1. We heard **thundering footsteps** upstairs.
我們聽到樓上**咚咚巨響的腳步聲**。
2. The waterfall made a **thundering noise**.
瀑布發出**震耳欲聾的轟鳴聲**。

21. thundering — very great / emphatic

Informal, especially BrE:

= extremely large, obvious, or forceful

極大的；十足的

Examples

1. That was a **thundering mistake**.
那是一個**大錯特錯的失誤**。
2. He told a **thundering lie**.
他說了一個**天大的謊話**。

Less common in modern neutral English.

Key contrasts

22. thunder vs lightning

****thunder****

= sound produced by the rapid expansion of heated air around lightning

****雷聲****

****lightning****

= electrical flash in the sky

****閃電****

You ****see lightning**** and ****hear thunder****.

23. thunder vs storm

****thunder****

= sound

****雷聲****

****storm****

= broader weather event involving strong wind, rain, snow, thunder, etc.

****暴風雨；風暴****

24. thunder vs rumble

****rumble****

= low, continuous, deep sound

****低沉隆隆聲****

****thunder****

= louder, more powerful sound, often metaphorically compared with natural thunder

****轟鳴；雷鳴般巨響****

Compare:

> distant rumble of traffic

> 遠處交通的低沉隆隆聲

> train thundered past

> 火車轟隆隆地駛過

25. thunder vs roar

****roar****

= very loud, deep continuous sound, often from animals, engines, crowds, fire, etc.

****吼叫；轟鳴****

****thunder****

= emphasizes heavy booming/rumbling force resembling thunder

****雷鳴般轟響****

They overlap in many figurative sound descriptions.

26. thunder vs crash

****crash****

= sudden loud impact sound

****砰然巨響；撞擊聲****

****thunder****

= often deeper, heavier, and potentially continuing

****雷鳴般轟聲****

Meaning map

The central concept of ****thunder**** is:

****the powerful booming sound associated with a storm****

From this develop:

Weather

thunder

→ ****雷聲****

Loud sound

thunder of engines

→ **引擎轟鳴**

Applause

thunder of applause

→ **雷鳴般掌聲**

Passage

roller coaster thundered overhead

→ **過山車轟隆隆地從頭頂駛過**

Movement

train thunders through

→ **火車轟鳴而過**

Human movement

children thunder downstairs

→ **孩子們咚咚作響地跑下樓**

Voice

he thundered

→ **他怒吼 / 厲聲說**

Idiom

steal someone's thunder

→ **搶某人風頭**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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thunder — weather noun	閃電後在天空產生的巨大雷聲 / 雷鳴
thunder — weather verb	天空發出雷聲；打雷
thunder — loud noise	類似雷聲的深沉、強烈巨響 / 轟鳴
thunder of applause	非常響亮、如雷般的掌聲
thunder — noisy movement	伴隨巨大轟鳴聲快速 / 沉重地移動
thunder past/through/along	轟隆隆地駛過 / 穿過 / 前進
thunder — heavy running	以沉重、響亮腳步快速奔跑
thunder — speak loudly	以非常洪亮、憤怒或威嚴的聲音說話

thunder against/at	大聲斥責、猛烈抨擊	
thunderous — sound	像雷聲般巨大、震耳欲聾的	
thunderous — response	極其強烈、聲勢浩大的	
thunderclap	突然而響亮的一聲雷鳴 / 霹靂	
thunderstorm	同時有雷、閃電，通常伴雨的雷暴 / 雷雨	
thunderbolt — literal/mythological	雷電 / 霹靂；神話中的雷霆	
like a thunderbolt	像晴天霹靂一樣突然帶來巨大衝擊	
steal someone's thunder	搶先奪去某人的注意、功勞或風頭	
thunder and lightning	雷鳴與閃電；雷電	
blood and thunder	充滿暴力、激烈動作和戲劇刺激的內容	
thundering — loud	發出巨大轟鳴 / 沉重聲響的	

Passage recap

> “Roller coasters ****thundered overhead****, music blasted from loudspeakers...”

Here:

****thunder**** = ****to move with a very loud, deep, rumbling noise****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****轟隆隆地駛過****

* ****發出巨響地高速移動****

* ****轟鳴而過****

Natural contextual translation:

****過山車在頭頂轟隆隆地駛過，擴音器則播放著震耳的音樂。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****thunder****

= ****to move or pass with a loud, deep, powerful noise resembling thunder****

****轟隆隆地移動；轟鳴而過****

The key semantic progression is:

> ****thunder in the sky****

> → 天空中的雷聲

then:

> ****thunder of engines****

> → 引擎的轟鳴

and finally:

> ****roller coasters thunder overhead****

> → ****過山車像雷聲一樣轟隆隆地從頭頂駛過****

The verb can then extend further to a human voice:

> "Leave!" he ****thundered****.

> → 「走開！」他****怒吼道****。

So the passage uses the ****loud powerful movement**** branch, not literal weather.